PRODUCT LEADERSHIP

My five favourite product words.

These are all words that I have taken to heart over the years. They form a little system of their own. A system that has helped me many times.

Spoiler: one of them is a feeling.



swipe →

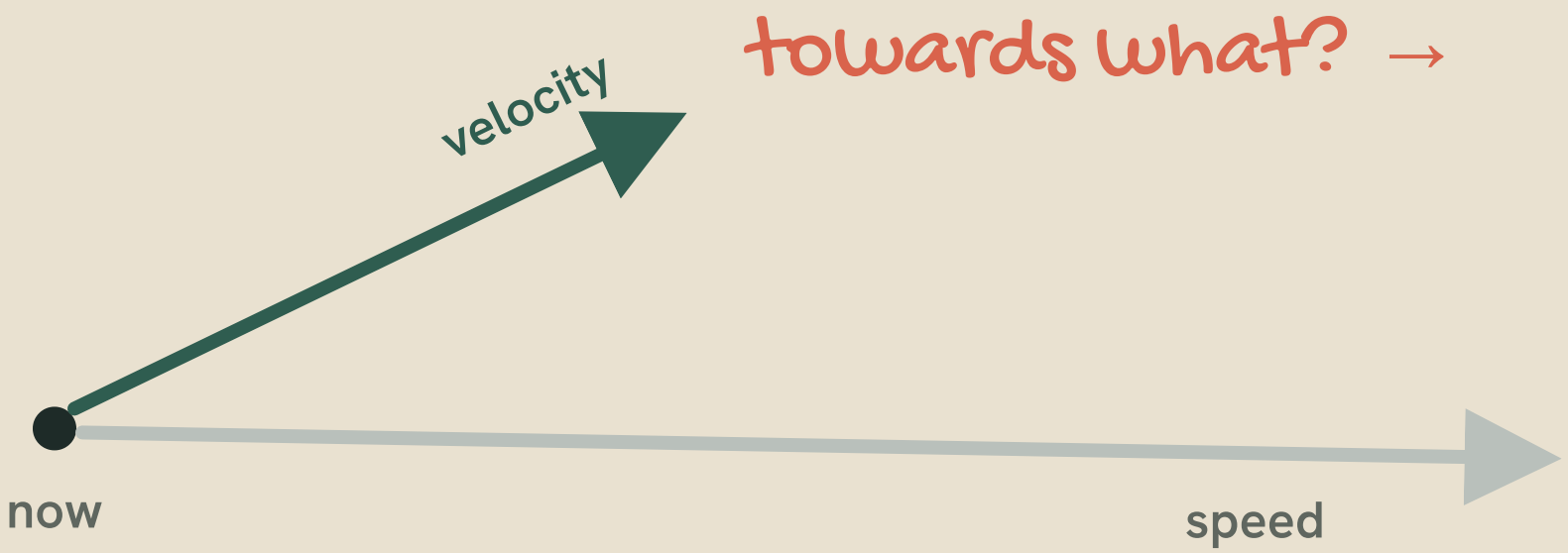
HÅKAN NILSSON

MY FIVE FAVOURITE PRODUCT WORDS

Velocity

Speed is how fast you move. Velocity is how fast you approach the objective.

You can work at a high speed and not get any closer.



MY FIVE FAVOURITE PRODUCT WORDS

Objective

Where are we going, and why? In terms that matter for the business.

- ✕ Ship one-click checkout
- ✓ More customers finish checkout on mobile

Not a feature. Not a technical milestone.



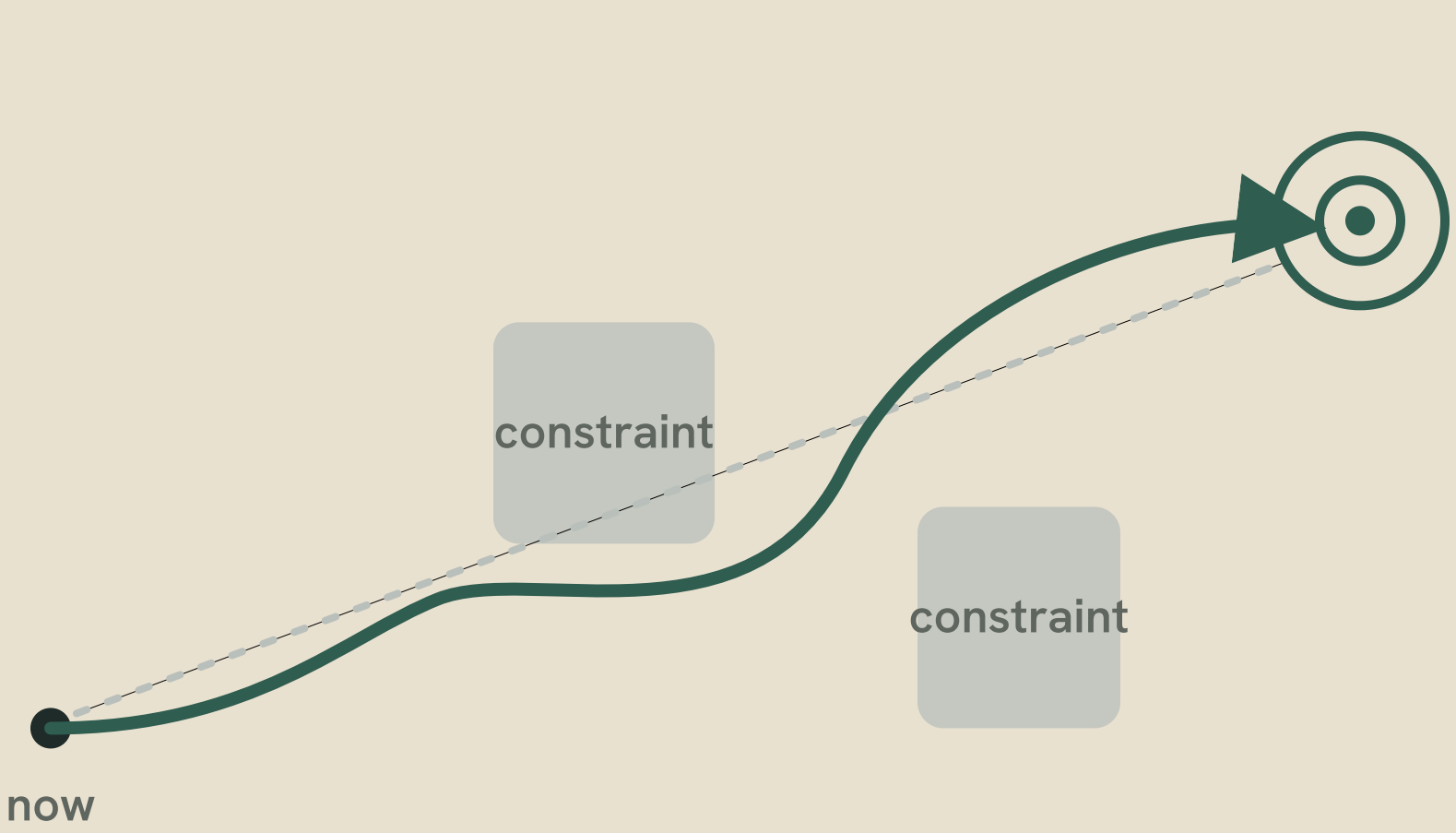
You can survive a while without a vision.
You won't last long without an objective.

MY FIVE FAVOURITE PRODUCT WORDS

Constraint

The neutral word for everything you have to respect on the way.

Limitations. Things to consider. Not complaints – part of the job.



That's why the arrow is almost never straight.

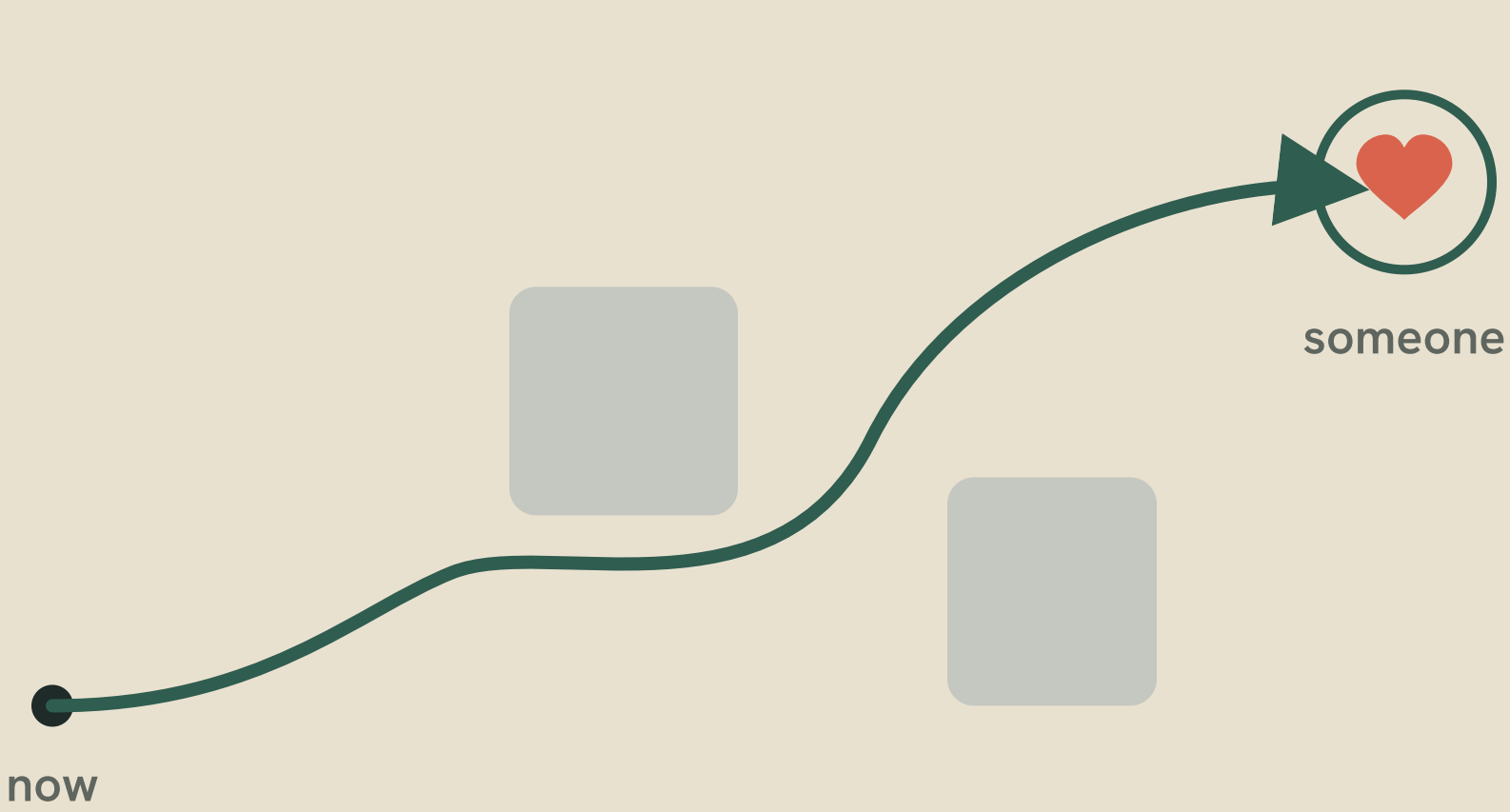
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MY FIVE FAVOURITE PRODUCT WORDS

Empathy

For the people you build for, and the people you build with.

Users first. Stakeholders too. Without empathy, it's just delivery.



Bring your heart into the game.

MY FIVE FAVOURITE PRODUCT WORDS

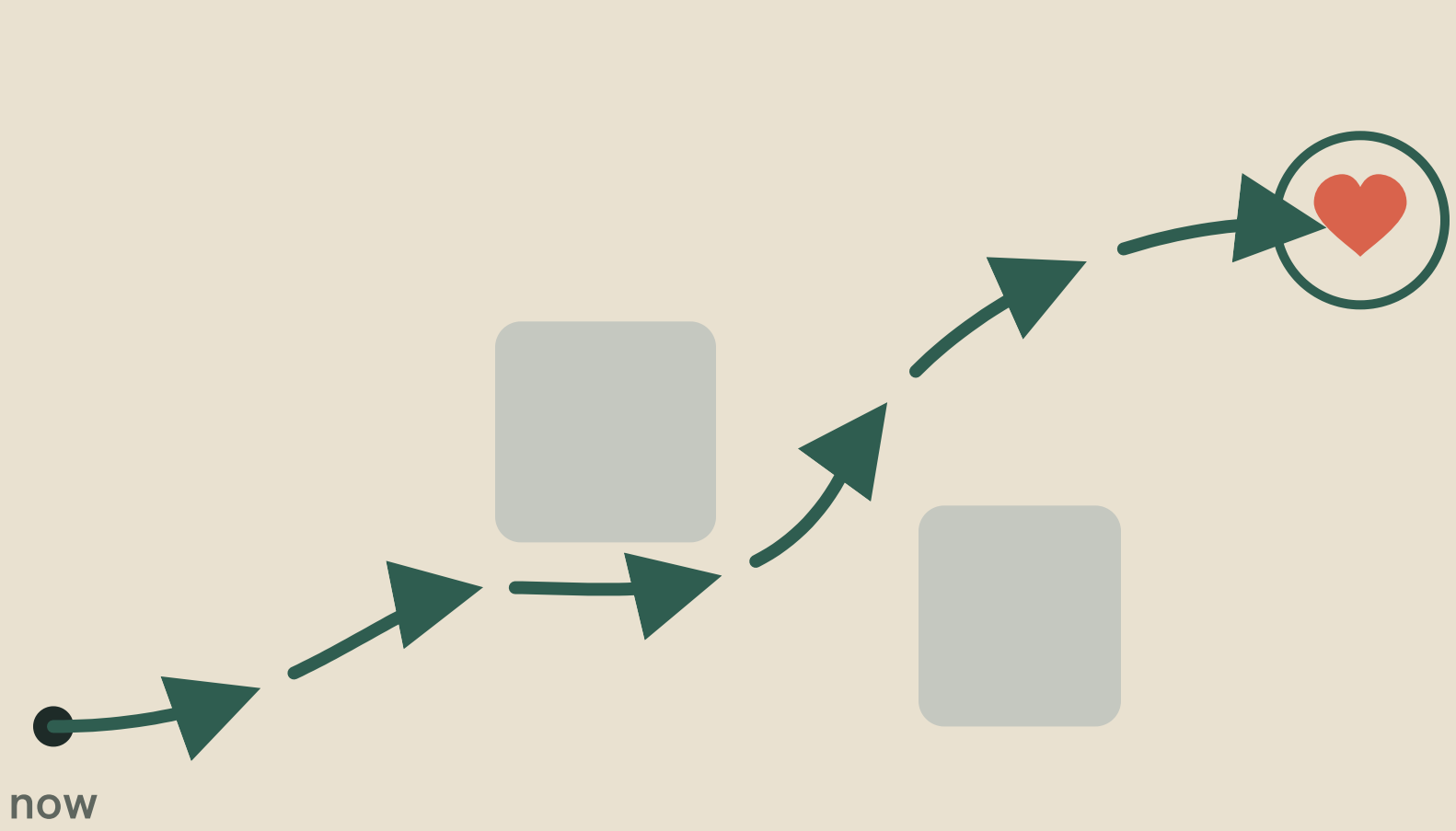
Batch size

Smaller batches, smaller steps. More chances to steer.

→ More and earlier feedback

→ More opportunities to adjust your course

→ Higher **velocity**, even if speed drops



Yes, two words.
Still a small batch.

OVER TO YOU

Five words. One small system. What's your favourite product word?

Håkan Nilsson
Product strategy, digital transformation & AI

